

Defensive forts

The Revolt of 1857 changed the way the British viewed the railways. Stations were now incorporated into the colonial defence strategy (see [Revolts and the Railways](#)). They also became potential shelters for the British if the need arose. The architecture of these stations began reflecting this change in ideology. Lahore is perhaps the best example. Built shortly after the Revolt, the station was, described author Rudyard Kipling, “the work of devils”, which was designed like a medieval European castle. It was an imposing structure with giant, sliding iron doors, tall walls with loopholes for muskets, and bomb-proof turreted towers. British anthropologist Laura Bear in her book, *Lines of the Nation* wrote about the post-1857 railway stations as changing from “places of commerce” to arenas “for the expression and protection of state authority and the hierarchical relationships of command.” The architecture and location, she wrote, “reflected a tension between a desire to materialize a neutral public sphere of commerce and a fear that Indian populations were hostile.”